CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

FLORIST IN THE AI ERA

Flowers die in a week and people still spend seriously on them — because the day they mark does not repeat.

★ **TL;DR — Around $45K median for hands-on design work you can start in 1–6 months, no license required. The catch: wholesale math and holiday marathons decide whether the art pays.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

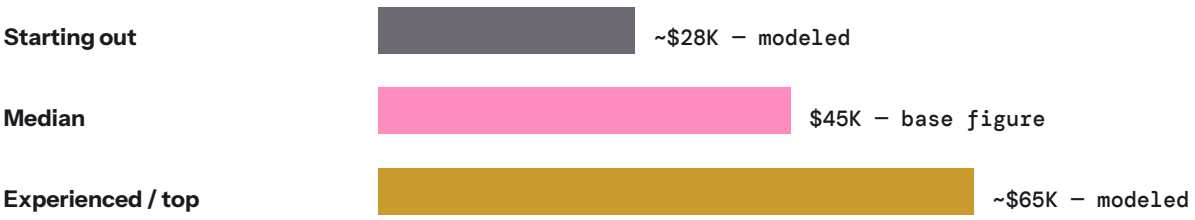
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: weddings, funerals, holidays and weekly corporate arrangements do not stop for economic moods.
- Where it bites: perishable inventory — every unsold stem is money in the compost.
- The AI angle: AI can take orders and draft designs, but it cannot condition roses at 5 a.m. or wire a bouquet that survives the day.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Florist is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A FLORIST ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Order, receive and condition fresh flowers before dawn markets

- ✓ Design arrangements, bouquets and event installations to order
- ✓ Run the cooler math: what to buy, what it must sell for, what is dying
- ✓ Deliver and set up weddings and events on the day

Think: a chef whose ingredients wilt by Friday — timing and waste are the whole business.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Online ordering, subscription logistics and design mock-ups are software now. Marketplaces intermediate more of the everyday order flow.	The craft is physical and perishable: choosing stems by touch, designing in the hand, and building installations on-site under wedding-day time pressure.

⚠ **The romance hides the math: Valentine's and Mother's Day make the year, and one over-ordered cooler can eat the profit of a month.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Work with living, beautiful material daily ✓ You are present at people's biggest days ✓ A shop smells better than any office	✗ Pre-dawn market runs and ice-cold coolers ✗ Holiday weeks are marathons, not celebrations ✗ Standing all day, hands in cold water

Good fit? You have an eye for color, fast hands, and respect for the unglamorous math of perishables.
Bad fit? You want gentle mornings, or you fall in love with inventory instead of selling it.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — FLOWER SHOP HAND	DOOR B — EVENT & WEDDING STUDIO
Shops hire for conditioning, delivery and design help, especially before holidays. You learn stem handling, cooler discipline and the shop's design language from the bucket up.	Freelance for wedding florists on event weekends: processing, setup, installations. Event work pays in intense bursts and teaches large-scale design faster than retail.

Smart move: Learn the business math early — cost per stem, markup, waste percentage. The florist who can price a wedding without bleeding is rarer than the florist with taste.
Where you land after: Lead designer, wedding and events studio owner, or a subscription-focused shop with steady weekly accounts.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN FLOWER	GET INTO	DESIGN FUNDAMENTAL	WEDDINGS AND	LEARN THE	BUILD YOUR

STEP 1 — Learn flower handling

FREE · WEEKS 1-2

- Conditioning, hydration, cooler storage by variety
- The names — you cannot sell what you cannot name

STEP 2 — Get into a shop

PAID · MONTH 1

- Apply before holiday rushes — shops hire hands then
- Processing and delivery first; design trust follows

STEP 3 — Design fundamentals

MONTHS 1-3

- Everyday arrangements, symmetry, mechanics and foam-free methods
- Speed matters: beautiful and fast is the standard

STEP 4 — Weddings and events

MONTHS 2-5

- Bouquets, centerpieces and installations on real timelines
- Learn setup logistics — the invisible half of event florals

STEP 5 — Learn the order book

MONTHS 3-6

- Wholesale buying, pricing formulas, waste tracking
- This is where shops live or die

STEP 6 — Build your lane

MONTH 6

- Weddings, subscriptions or retail — pick the profitable one
- A signature look makes the marketing write itself

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: learn twenty common flowers and how each is conditioned.
- Days 1–30: start in a shop; master processing, buckets and cooler discipline.
- Days 31–60: build everyday arrangements to the shop's standard and speed.
- Days 61–90: work a wedding or event setup end to end.
- Day 90: a real shop hand turning designer — taste plus cooler math is the promotion.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **BEAUTY, BEFORE IT WILTS.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.